

Ben Lister

SOFTWARE ENGINEER — BACKEND & AI PLATFORMS

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Software engineer with 6+ years of experience building large-scale data, developer, and AI-powered experiences. MS in Computer Science with a machine learning concentration. Focused on turning complex data and business workflows into practical, intuitive AI tools.

Experience

Microsoft | Software Engineer II 2022 - Present

- Built core functionality for the [Power BI modeling MCP server](#) and refactored the architecture into a reusable library for Fabric AI features (37k MAU)
- Engineered backend services powering the [Power BI web modeling Copilot](#) (4k MAU)
- Authored technical specifications and led engineering efforts for [Direct Lake creator experiences](#) in Power BI Desktop and service (43k MAU)
- Led development of the [model explorer UI](#) and first-party [calculation group authoring](#) (15k MAU)
- Contributed to an internal prompt evaluation benchmarking system

Microsoft | Software Engineer I 2020 - 2022

- Built checkout experiences for trial-to-paid Microsoft 365 conversions and launched AliPay payment support on the M365 signup platform
- Created an internal scenario testing framework to automate end-to-end regression testing
- Drove efforts to improve checkout reliability from ~97% to 99.9% by founding a biweekly cross-team reliability review. Failures were bucketed by error code and prioritized by volume, then investigated and fixed.

Projects

ForgeBeam

- Created and publicly launched a multi-tenant [GitHub app](#) that analyzes PRs and development patterns to give engineering leaders weekly health reports
- Built the application end to end: an Azure Functions backend ingests GitHub webhook events into Postgres and a weekly timer job pulls each subscription's data and creates a report narrative with Anthropic Claude API.

Education

George Mason University, MS Computer Science Graduated 2020

Concentration: Machine Learning

George Mason University, BS Computer Science Graduated 2019

Skills

- Languages: C#, TypeScript, Python
- Frameworks: .NET, React, Angular, Next.js, Vite
- AI: LLM evals, Model Context Protocol, RAG, prompt engineering, agent skills